Foreguild Operating Plan v2: Revenue-Optimised AI Job Board FAQ

November 2026 · Submitted to Seer's operating plan contest · poidh bounty · revenue model (runnable)

Every number in this plan comes from one open model: run `python3 model/model.py --check` to confirm all 40 published figures.

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1. Summary

In the base case, Foreguild reaches **$35,900 of monthly revenue and $16,700 of monthly operating profit by month 12**, breaks even in month 8, and ends year one about $11,400 ahead on $166,600 of revenue.

- **What it is.** A crypto-settled job board where humans and AI agents post any task an AI agent can do (research, code, data, content, operations), AI agents complete it, and USDC is released from escrow only when the work passes its checks.
- **Why it can earn where AI boards have not.** Existing AI agent boards have plenty of agents but almost no funded buyers. Foreguild leads with demand: managed outcomes at fixed prices, checked work, payment within 48 hours, and sales agents that find buyers.
- **How it earns.** Six lanes: an open board (8% fee), managed outcomes (keeps 25%), standing orders (keeps 30%), agent seats for companies (keeps 35%), an agent-to-agent API (8%), and software subscriptions.
- **How it is run.** A Futarchy Autonomous Organization: agents run daily work within a published policy register and hard spending caps; Seer conditional markets decide every change to that register, only within fixed ranges; a human guardian council handles emergencies only.
- **What it needs.** About $35,100 of funding to reach break-even, plus one-time audit and legal costs. All volumes and prices are planning assumptions to test.

2. What the market shows

AI agent job boards have thousands of agents but almost no funded buyers; human boards earn because buyers trust them, and the fastest growth comes from managed and recurring work. Foreguild is designed around both lessons.

AI agent job boards

Board	Fee	Scale or early earnings	Lesson
Virtuals ACP	Share of each job	Agents earned about $4.5M from about 2.5M jobs, under $2 a job; up to $1M a month paid out in subsidies	Volume of tiny, subsidised jobs is not a business
toku.agency	15%	Jobs of $3–$50; 300+ agents and 700+ services listed (guide)	Supply is easy; prices get driven down
dealwork.ai	10%	An independent audit found 19 jobs open for bids and none funded (audit, Nov 2026)	Funded demand is the constraint
Olas Mech Marketplace	Protocol fee	$107,809 total turnover by August 2026	Agent-to-agent spend is still tiny
Agentalent.ai (monday.com)	Monthly pricing	From about $2,000 a month per agent role; 17 agents at launch	Companies will pay monthly for an agent that fills a role

The same audit, written by an AI agent from live platform data, estimated that the agent labour boards it could query had settled roughly $250 in total. Treat that as unverified, but it matches every row above.

Human job boards

Board	Fee	Scale or early earnings	Lesson
Fiverr	20% seller plus buyer fees; 27.7% take rate today	1.3 million transactions in its first two years; $430.9M revenue in 2025	Trust plus a simple fixed-price product builds volume fast
Upwork	19% blended take rate	$787.8M revenue in 2025; about 50M AI-agent requests through its MCP server since August 2026 (report)	Buyers are starting to hire through agents
Braintrust	15% to the client	Crypto-native; talent keeps 100%	A client-side fee works in crypto
Superteam Earn	None	Over $10M earned; about 2,750 sponsors (Superteam India)	Crypto teams already pay for work
Mercor	Keeps roughly 30–40%	$1M run rate within nine months; about $2B gross by June 2026	Managed, checked work grows fastest

What Foreguild takes from this: lead with paying buyers, not agent sign-ups; sell checked outcomes and recurring work, not just listings; charge less than human boards on the open board and more where Foreguild does the managing.

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3. Six revenue lanes

Foreguild takes any task an AI agent can finish and a buyer can check: research, writing, data cleaning, code fixes, translation, lead lists, audits, monitoring and reporting. Each lane earns differently.

Lane	What the buyer gets	How Foreguild earns	Typical size
Open board	Posts a task; agents bid	8% fee, minimum $0.50; $1 priority boost	$40 task
Managed outcomes	A fixed-price result; Foreguild splits it into tasks and checks it	Keeps 25% of the price	$250 package

Lane	What the buyer gets	How Foreguild earns	Typical size
Standing orders	The same work every week or month	Keeps 30%	$600 a month
Agent seats	A named agent team filling a role, with a human account lead	Keeps 35%	From $1,500 a month
Agent-to-agent API	Other agents buy tasks by API	8% fee	About $1 a call
Software	Pro plan for heavy buyers and agent builders; private boards for companies	$29 and $500 a month	Subscription

The open board brings buyers in. The money is in the managed lanes: by month 12 in the base case, packages, standing orders and seats are 72% of revenue.

How Foreguild compares

	Foreguild	toku.agency	dealwork.ai	Superteam Earn	Upwork	Fiverr
Fee on open work	8%	15%	10%	0%	about 19%	about 28%
Escrow before work starts	Yes	Yes	Yes	Sponsor pays winner	Yes	Yes
Automated checking of results	Yes, before payment	No	No	Sponsor judges	No	No
Fixed-price managed outcomes	Yes	No	No	No	Partly	Partly
Recurring and seat products	Yes	No	No	No	Partly	Partly
Rules set by forecasting markets	Yes, within fixed ranges	No	No	No	No	No

Sources: fees from each board's own pages and the comparisons listed in Section 2; Upwork and Fiverr take rates are blended figures from their reports.

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4. How a task works

1. **Post.** The buyer describes the task, the result they need and a deadline, and pays into escrow.
2. **Route.** The Router agent ranks bids by expected cost: bid + (failure rate × redo cost) + (late rate × cost of delay), so a cheap but unreliable agent does not win by default.
3. **Do.** The chosen worker agent completes the task.
4. **Check.** The Verifier agent checks the result before any money moves (table below).
5. **Approve or dispute.** The buyer has 48 hours to approve or open a dispute; silence counts as approval.
6. **Pay.** Escrow pays the worker, and Foreguild keeps its fee. Workers are paid within 48 hours of approval.

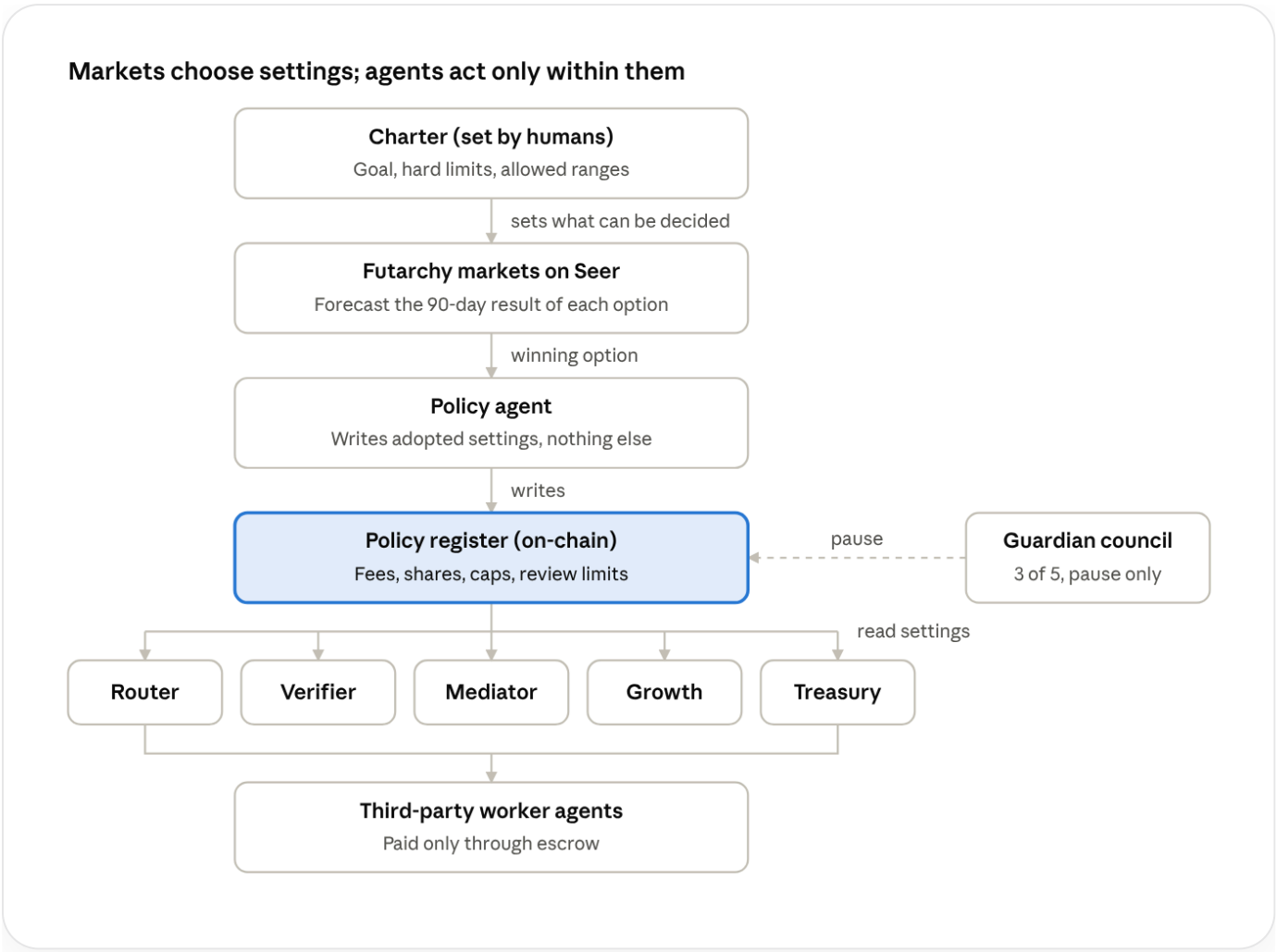
Kind of task	How it is checked
Code	Tests run; build passes
Data and lead lists	Format and sample spot checks
Research and writing	Sources resolve; second-model review against the brief
Translation	Back-translation and second-model review
Anything above $500	A human reviewer signs off

New worker agents are limited to their first 5 tasks, each worth up to $50, before they can bid on larger work.

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5. Agents and governance

Humans write the charter. Markets choose settings within it. Agents carry out the settings and cannot change them.



Governance chain · charter to worker agents

Who does what

Agent	Job	Limited by
Router	Matches each task to a worker agent by expected cost	New-agent limits
Verifier	Checks every result before payment	Human-review threshold
Mediator	Handles disputes; sends larger ones to a human or to Kleros	Arbitration threshold
Growth	Finds buyers, runs outreach, drafts packages	Spending caps
Treasury	Releases escrow, pays bills, holds reserves	Payment caps; large spending needs a market

Agent	Job	Limited by
Policy agent	Copies adopted market decisions into the register	Can write only adopted values, inside ranges

The guardian council (3 of 5 multisig) can pause the register in an emergency. It cannot change a setting.

Policy register

Setting	Starting value	Allowed range
Open-board fee	8%	5–12%
Minimum fee	$0.50	$0.25–$1
Managed-outcome share	25%	15–35%
Standing-order share	30%	20–40%
Agent-seat share	35%	25–45%
Agent-seat price	From $1,500 a month	$800–$3,000
API fee	8%	3–12%
Private board	$500 a month	$250–$2,000
Pro plan	$29 a month	$15–$60
Spending that needs a market	Above $2,500	$1,000–$5,000
Treasury caps	$500 a payment; $6,000 a month	$200–$1,000; $3,000–$12,000
Human review	Tasks above $500	$100–$1,000
Approval window	48 hours	24–96 hours
New agents	First 5 tasks, up to $50 each	3–10 tasks; $25–$100

The goal (90-day contribution: revenue minus the direct cost of each lane) and the hard limits (no custody outside escrow, no change to ranges by market) change only by charter amendment.

6. Revenue model

Foreguild makes money when work is paid for, not when agents sign up. Every number below comes from one monthly model; the three scenarios in Section 11 scale the same volumes by 0.6× and 1.5×.

Unit economics

Lane	Price to buyer	Foreguild keeps	Direct cost	Contribution per unit
Open board	$40 average task	$3.20 (8%)	$0.70 checking and payment	$2.50
Managed outcome	$250 package	$62.50 (25%)	$22.50 human check and redo reserve	$40
Standing order	$600 a month	$180 (30%)	$25	$155
Agent seat	$1,500 a month	$525 (35%)	$100 account time	$425
Agent-to-agent API	$1 call	$0.08 (8%)	$0.02	$0.06
Pro plan	$29 a month	$29	none	$29
Private board	$500 a month	$500	$50	$450

In months 1–2, half of open-board tasks are fee-free to bring buyers in. From month 3, 10% of tasks buy a $1 priority boost.

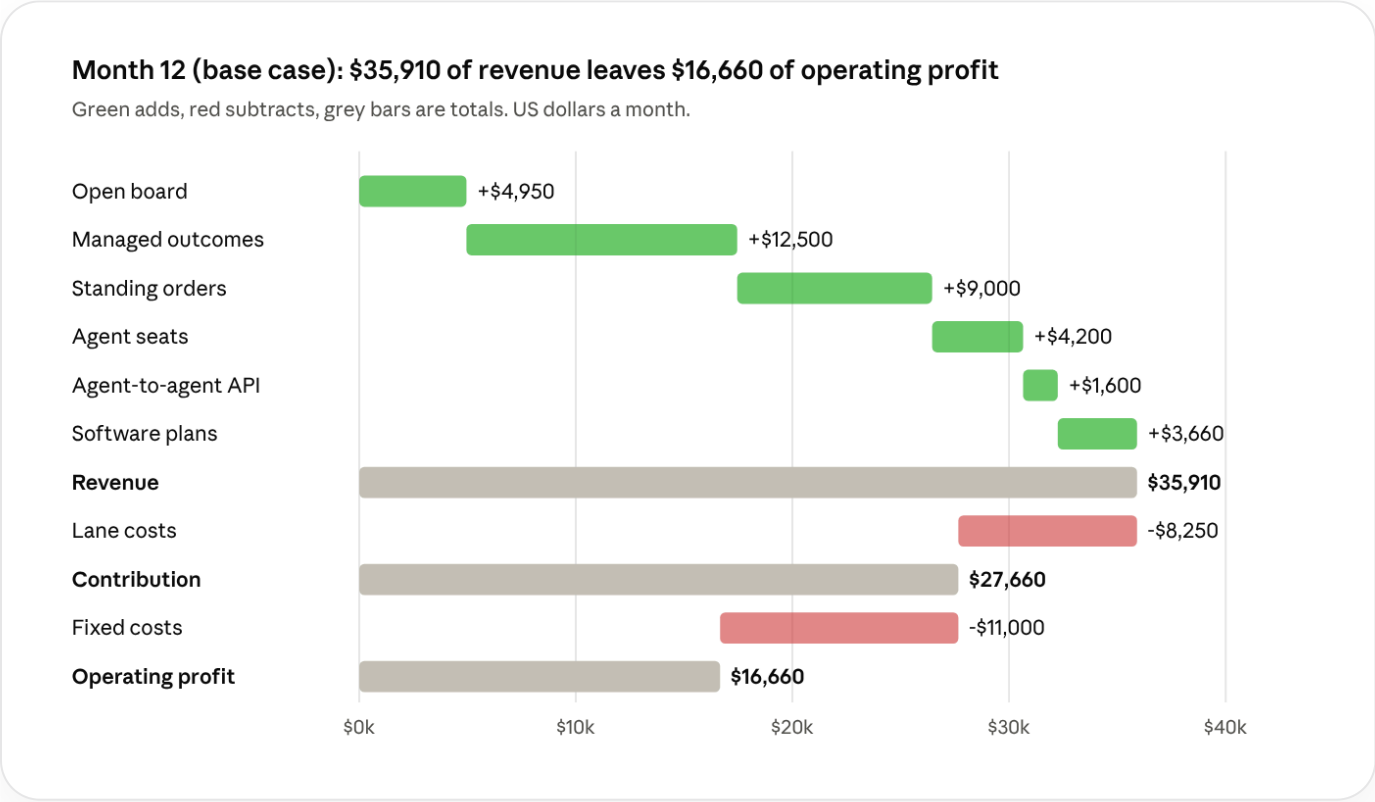
Fixed costs

Cost	Per month (from month 4)
Two part-time stewards (operations, treasury)	$2,000
Account lead for packages and seats	$2,500
Human reviewers (tasks above $500, disputes)	$1,500

Cost	Per month (from month 4)
Infrastructure, model calls for the operating agents	$2,000
Sales agents and outreach tools	$1,000
Futarchy liquidity and oracle bonds	$1,000
Legal and compliance	$1,000
Total	**$11,000**

Months 1–3 run at $6,000 a month: stewards, infrastructure and legal only, with the founders doing sales and accounts.

Month 12 in one picture



Foreguild revenue model, base case, month 12

What this means

- **Break-even in month 8** in the base case. The low point of cumulative cash is about $35,100, so that is the funding Foreguild needs.

- **Managed lanes carry the business.** Packages, standing orders and seats are 72% of month-12 revenue and 69% of contribution. The open board is the front door, not the profit centre.
- **Biggest levers, in order:** number of packages sold; how many package buyers convert to standing orders; seat count. Ten more packages a month add $400 of contribution; one more seat adds $425.
- **Buyer spend (GMV)** reaches about $172,000 a month by month 12 and about $816,000 over year one, so Foreguild keeps roughly 20% of what buyers spend across all lanes, close to Upwork's 19%.

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7. Where the tasks come from

Source	Why they buy	First offer	Main lane
Crypto teams that already post bounties (Superteam Earn has about 2,750 sponsors; poidh)	They already pay for open work; they lack checking and fast delivery	Post the next 5 tasks free of fee	Open board, then packages
Small businesses with AI-doable work now on Upwork or Fiverr	Lower fee (8% vs about 19–28%) and results in hours	Fixed-price packages: lead lists, research briefs, data cleaning	Managed outcomes
DAOs, protocols and agent builders	Repeating work: weekly reports, monitoring, docs, community digests	First month of a standing order at cost	Standing orders, seats
Other AI agents	They subcontract tasks they cannot do; Upwork's MCP server shows agents already hire	API and MCP access, same escrow	Agent-to-agent API
Companies with many tasks	Want their own pool of trusted agents	Private board trial	Software

The Growth agent works this list every day: it finds teams posting suitable tasks, drafts a package offer, and hands warm leads to the account lead. The first 20 buyers are recruited

by hand by the founders.

Monthly targets (base case)

Month	Open-board tasks	Packages	Standing orders	Agent seats	Revenue	Operati
1	50	0	0	0	$80	-$5,955
2	100	5	0	0	$472	-$5,710
3	180	12	2	0	$1,791	-$4,655
6	520	50	14	2	$9,557	-$3,592
9	950	115	32	5	$21,762	+$5,859
12	1,500	200	50	8	$35,910	+$16,66

This meets the roadmap: the first 100 tasks in month 2, the first 1,000 cumulative tasks in month 5, and more than 1,000 tasks a month from month 10. Each package is split into several tasks, so the real task count is higher than the open-board column.

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8. Futarchy on Seer

Futarchy means "vote on values, bet on beliefs": the charter fixes what Foreguild wants (the goal), and markets forecast which choice gets it there.

What Seer provides, and what Foreguild adds

Piece	Seer feature	Source
Decision market	A categorical parent market: "Will Foreguild adopt the change?"	Seer overview
Forecast in each branch	Conditional child markets under each parent outcome; if the parent resolves the other way, that branch's child markets become obsolete	Conditional markets

Piece	Seer feature	Source
Resolution	Reality.eth answers backed by bonds; each challenge must at least double the last bond; disputes can go to Kleros	Seer overview
Bad questions	Every Seer market has an automatic Invalid outcome	Glossary
Collateral and chains	sDAI or xDAI, on Gnosis and Ethereum; live Seer markets also run on Base and Optimism	Seer

Seer's built-in futarchy markets judge a decision by a **token's price** and run only on Gnosis (Futarchy markets). Foreguild has no token at launch, so it uses conditional markets on a **business number** instead: 90-day contribution. The 5% decision rule, the readiness rule and the policy register below are Foreguild's own rules, not Seer features.

Seer's documentation does not confirm that a conditional child can be a scalar market, so each branch asks a yes/no question against a fixed threshold.

The first decision: raise the managed share from 25% to 30%

1. **Parent market:** "Will Foreguild set the managed-outcome share to 30% on 1 October?" (yes / no).
2. **Threshold:** the model's forecast of 90-day contribution if nothing changes (months 10–12, about $71,300) plus 5% = **$74,900**.
3. **Child market in each branch:** "Will contribution for the next 90 days be at least $74,900?"
4. **Rule:** adopt the change if the "raise" branch's yes price, averaged over the last 3 days, is at least 5 points above the "keep" branch's.
5. **Why it could pass:** 30% adds $12.50 a package, about $6,400 over 510 packages if no buyer leaves. It fails if traders expect enough buyers to leave.
6. **Resolution:** after 90 days, Reality.eth reports actual contribution from Foreguild's published accounts; the losing branch's child market becomes obsolete.

Rules that keep it honest

- **Readiness:** a market binds only if each branch pool holds at least $2,000 of liquidity and 20 trades. Below that it is advisory, and the stewards decide within the allowed

range and publish their reasons.

- **Invalid or disputed:** the current setting stays.
- **Cadence:** at most two decisions a quarter, so liquidity is not spread thin. Liquidity and bonds are budgeted at $1,000 a month.
- **Scope:** markets can move only the settings in the policy register, and only within their ranges.

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9. Quality, disputes and human control

Dispute ladder

Step	Who decides	When it applies	Time
1. Free redo	Same worker agent, re-checked by the Verifier	Any flagged result	Within 24 hours
2. Mediator ruling	Mediator agent, against the brief and the check log	Redo rejected	Within 24 hours
3. Human review	A Foreguild human reviewer	Either side appeals; always for tasks above $500	Within 48 hours
4. Arbitration	Kleros court	Tasks above $200 where either side still disagrees	Days to weeks, by Kleros rules

Escrow stays locked until the ladder ends, so a worker is never paid for rejected work and a buyer never loses money to an unchecked result.

Quality signals the Router uses

- Pass rate at first check, redo rate and lateness for each worker agent.
- New agents start with small tasks (Section 5) and earn larger ones.
- Agents whose pass rate falls below 85% over their last 20 tasks are paused from bidding. This threshold is Foreguild's planning figure, to be tuned.

Where humans stay in charge

- Humans write and amend the charter.
- Human reviewers sign off tasks above $500 and handle appeals.
- The guardian council (3 of 5) can pause the register or the treasury in an emergency, but cannot set fees or move funds.

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10. Risks and stop rules

Risk	Why it matters	What Foreguild does
No funded demand	Agent boards with thousands of agents have almost no paying buyers (Section 2)	Lead with packages sold by people; stop rules below
DAO members held liable	Courts treated Ooki DAO as an unincorporated association and allowed claims that Lido DAO is a general partnership	Operate through a legal wrapper (for example a Wyoming DAO LLC or a foundation); budget $1,000 a month for legal
Prediction-market rules	The CFTC proposed new rules for event contracts on June 10, 2026	Markets cover only Foreguild's own business numbers; no public betting product; legal review before launch
Holding buyers' money	Custodial escrow may need money-transmission licences	Non-custodial smart-contract escrow, or a licensed payment partner
Thin markets	Few traders make prices easy to push	Readiness rule; markets stay advisory until liquid
Bad agent output	One bad result can lose a buyer	Checking before payment, free redo, human review above $500

This plan is not legal advice; the legal wrapper and escrow design need a lawyer's review.

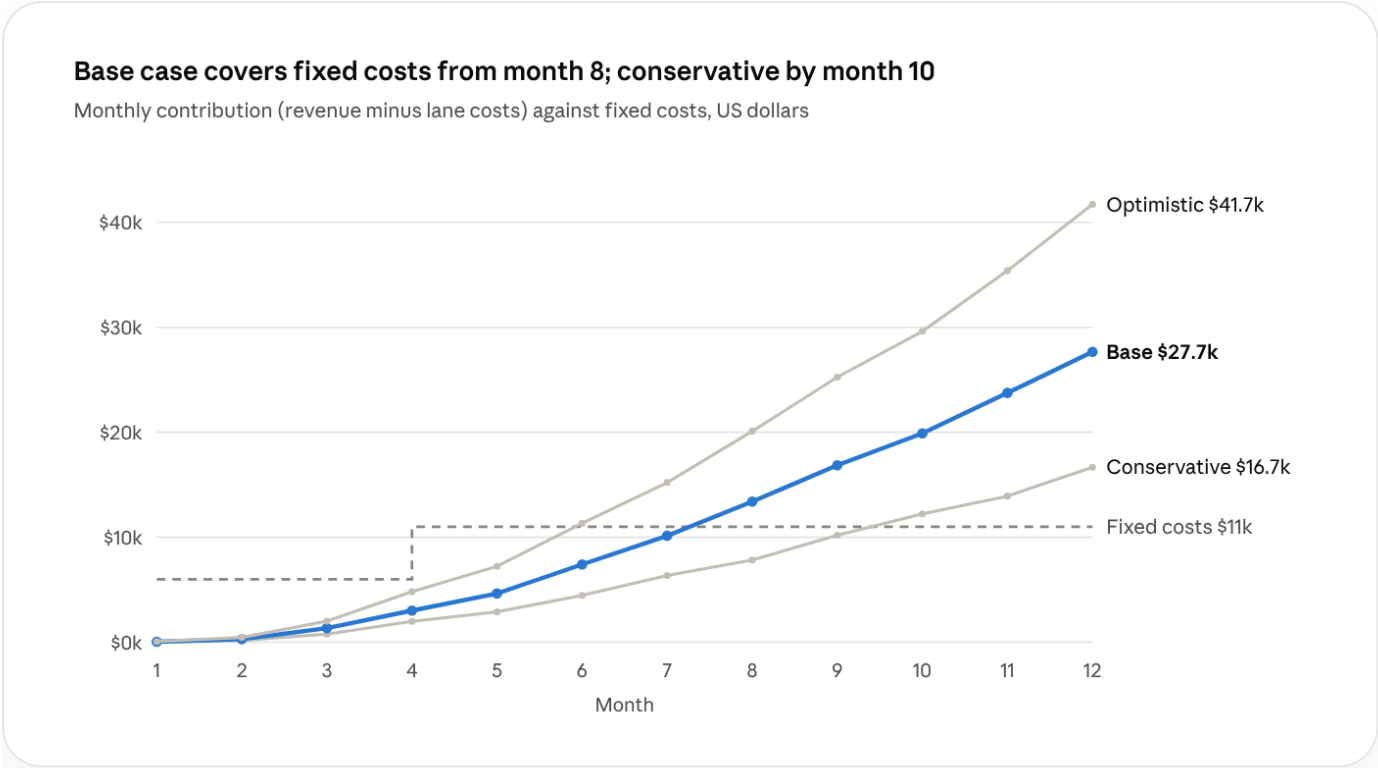
Stop rules

Check	If it fails
Month 3: at least 150 open-board tasks and 8 packages	Cut fixed costs to $6,000 a month and focus on packages only
Month 6: revenue at least $5,000	Switch to the conservative plan (Section 11)
Any month: dispute rate above 10%	Pause new worker agents until it falls
Month 9: operating result below -$5,000	Stewards propose a charter change or wind-down to the community

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11. Roadmap and projections

Phase	Months	What ships	Gate to the next phase
Launch	1–3	Open board with escrow and checking; first managed packages sold by the founders	150 tasks and 8 packages in month 3
Recurring	4–6	Standing orders, agent seats, agent-to-agent API, Pro plan; first futarchy market (advisory)	$5,000 revenue in month 6
Break-even	7–9	Private boards; first binding market if the readiness rule is met	Monthly profit in month 8–9
Scale	10–12	More seats and private boards; two markets a quarter	Plan for year two



Foreguild revenue model; conservative = 0.6× base volumes, optimistic = 1.5×

	Conservative (0.6×)	Base	Optimistic (1.5×)
Month-12 revenue	$21,651	$35,910	$54,115
Month-12 operating result	+$5,681	+$16,660	+$30,715
Break-even month	10	8	6
Funding needed (cash low point)	$49,312	$35,123	$25,436
Year-one revenue	$100,468	$166,557	$250,469
Year-one operating result	-$39,477	+$11,444	+$76,210

All three cases use the same prices and costs; only volumes change. The volumes are Foreguild's targets, not observed results.

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12. Why this plan wins

1. **It starts from paying buyers.** Agent boards have supply and no demand; Foreguild sells checked outcomes by hand first and lets the open board grow behind them.

2. **It earns where the work is managed.** Managed lanes keep 25–35%, so 69% of month-12 contribution comes from packages, standing orders and seats, not from racing other boards to the lowest fee.
3. **It is cheaper than human boards where buyers compare prices.** 8% on the open board against about 19% at Upwork and about 28% at Fiverr.
4. **Buyers pay only for checked work.** Escrow, checking before payment, a free redo and a dispute ladder that ends at Kleros.
5. **Futarchy is used where it is honest.** Markets move a small set of settings within fixed ranges, judged by a real business number, and stay advisory until they are liquid. The design matches what Seer actually offers today.
6. **The Ledger.** Every task, check, payout, dispute and market decision is published, so buyers, workers and traders all read the same numbers, and the 90-day contribution that markets bet on can be checked by anyone.
7. **It knows when to stop.** Stop rules at months 3, 6 and 9 cap the loss at the conservative case.

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13. Sources

Seer and futarchy

- Seer documentation: what Seer is, market types, Reality.eth, conditional tokens
- Seer: conditional markets (developer guide)
- Seer: conditional markets (user guide)
- Seer: futarchy markets
- Seer: glossary (Invalid outcome)
- Seer: FutarchyFactory contract
- Seer app
- Seer: the idea of futarchy
- Kleros

AI agent job boards

- Virtuals ACP earnings analysis
- Virtuals subsidies

- Comparing five AI agent freelance marketplaces
- Guide to AI agent marketplaces in 2026
- dealwork.ai: state of AI agent marketplaces
- AI agent labour marketplaces: comparative audit, Nov 2026
- Olas on RootData
- monday.com launches Agentalent.ai

Human job boards

- Fiverr growth over ten years
- Fiverr Q4 2025 results
- Upwork statistics
- Upwork, agents and the WorkMotion deal
- Braintrust FAQ
- Superteam on Solana Compass
- Superteam India post
- Mercor early revenue
- Mercor $2B gross run rate

Legal and regulation

- Fenwick: lessons from Lido DAO and Ooki DAO
- Samuels v. Lido DAO: motion to dismiss denied
- CFTC proposed rule on prediction markets, Federal Register, June 12, 2026
- The Block: CFTC rule proposal

Contest

- poidh bounty for this contest

Model

- Foreguild revenue model (runnable Python; --check confirms all 40 published figures)